4. Focus on ‘soft power’ which can be said to be utilizing cultural diplomacy and interacting with India Diaspora, and
5. Eliminations of constraints while engaging with other countries.

It can be said that the focus is now on South Asia, South-East Asia (from Look-East to Act-East), Far-East, Central Asia, rediscovery of the importance of Indian Ocean, strengthening of cultural linkages, winning the Diaspora and renewed focus on climate change, nuclear power and terrorism.

As a part of his ‘Act-East Policy’ PM Modi gave a strategic boost with the inauguration of Bogibeel bridge in December 2018. It is about 4.9 km long over the River Brahmaputra and connects Dibrugarh to Dhemaji (Assam and Arunachal Pradesh). The Bogibeel bridge is the longest rail-cum road bridge in India. This can act as a game changer as it has fortified the Indo-China border. Another bridge has been the Dhola-Sadiya beam bridge in upper Assam’s Tinsukia district linking Assam and Arunachal Pradesh.

The other high points of the first term of PM Modi have been the surgical strikes by India across the Line of Control following the Uri terror attack in September 2016. There was also failed attempt of Pakistan to internationalize the Kashmir issue at the United Nations. India was successful in garnering support of the US, the UK, France, Germany, Japan, and South Korea. The Organisation of Islamic Cooperation (OIC) also condemned the Uri terrorist attack. The SAARC Summit to be held in Islamabad was called off as a mark of protest by the member states.

Following the Pulwama terror attacks on the jawans in February 2019, India carried another round of surgical strikes in Balakot, Pakistan. There was worldwide condemnation of the Pulwama terror attack. The US even urged Pakistan to cooperate in investigation and punish the offenders. However, China blocked the UN Security Council resolution to declare the mastermind behind the attack, Masood Azhar as a global terrorist for a long time. Only in May 2019, China pulled out the blockade and Masood Azhar was declared as a global terrorist.

The 2019 Lok Sabha elections was a big win for the NDA with the BJP getting 303 seats alone and NDA total of 353 seats. The second